

One of the most important concepts, when it comes to best practices of software development, is that they don't end with software development. Testing, or the stage which developers have the strongest love/hate relationship with, has some of the most stringent guidelines that are ignored the most often.

And once everything is done, and the program needs to be deployed, don't be bringing out the wine and preparing the feast just yet - deployment has its own share of guidelines and optimisations which could make or break the entire project.

Be it Java or Python, Github or Soureforge, Eclipse or Netbeans, each and every tool that has enabled you to achieve your goal in software development so far also needs to be handled with care. Each of these, due to their specialised abilities, can be optimised greatly if you know the best way to approach their usage.

And in the end, it is up to you to decide which best practices are relevant to your project. It may or may not be necessary for you to follow a particular testing process, or use a particular development methodology. Once you've figured that out and went down the right rabbit hole, you'll a better coder. 